

Pia Anderson

Director of User Experience

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SUMMARY

I lead design teams that deliver in code, not just Figma files. Over 20 years I have built UX practices inside resistant organizations, designed complex operational software, and shaped how enterprise teams work with AI. I currently direct an 80-person design capability at PwC while designing and shipping front-end code alongside engineering pods. My background spans hands-on design craft and design system architecture as well as organizational transformation across high-stakes platforms where speed, accuracy, and trust are non-negotiable.

EXPERIENCE

PricewaterhouseCoopers

9+ years

Director of User Experience · PwC Advisory

Jun 2021 – Present

- Designed the unified UX vision for Agent OS, PwC's firm-wide AI agent orchestration platform, now a 2026 CIO 100 Award winner. Conducted stakeholder research across three competing internal efforts, created the Figma prototype, and produced the client-facing demo video. The platform orchestrates 250+ deployed agents, enables workflow creation up to 10x faster than traditional methods, and earned a patent-pending designation for its orchestration system.
- Led the UX vision and strategy for Project Forge, an AI-first platform unifying budget creation, staffing, and engagement monitoring across three legacy systems. Delivered front-end code directly into the codebase, opening pull requests, responding to code reviews, and merging my own work alongside the engineering pod. Currently entering pilot with a partner team (July 2026).
- Directing an 80-person design capability across UX, accessibility, creative, and customer experience. Leading the transformation from Figma-artifact delivery to AI-first front-end code delivery through GitHub, using Claude Code, Claude Design, Cursor, and structured PR workflows.
- Led a full redesign of Concourse, PwC's internal collaboration platform, modernizing the experience and visual design system while introducing a flexible sub-system that balanced team autonomy with organizational consistency.
- Championed accessibility as a core build requirement across the portfolio, integrating full keyboard navigation into user stories, design specs, and QA acceptance criteria.

EXPERIENCE
CONTINUED

PricewaterhouseCoopers (continued)

Senior Manager, User Experience · PwC Digital

Mar 2019 – Jun 2021

- Grew the UX team from 7 to over 130 globally within PwC Digital during a period of rapid expansion. Owned recruiting and onboarding, and designed a team culture that became a retention advantage.
- Evolved design strategy and collaboration practices across Advisory technology initiatives. Established peer reviews and knowledge-sharing sessions that scaled as the team grew from a handful of designers to a global practice.
- Mentored managers and senior designers across multiple product lines in design operations and systems thinking, with a sustained focus on inclusive design practices.

UX Manager · PwC Tax Technology

Jan 2017 – Mar 2019

- Led the initiative that moved PwC Tax Technology from NN/g UX Maturity Stage 1 (Absent) to Stage 5 (Integrated) across 8 to 10 products in two years. Was one of three founding UX practitioners in an organization of 240+ engineers, PMs, and QA who had never worked with a designer.
- Built the first unified design system for Tax Technology and brought in an agency to scale it across the full product suite via CDN distribution, enabling immediate adoption without bottlenecking on the UX team.
- Organized and drove org-wide NN/g UX certification for 60 to 80 team members across engineering, PM, and QA roles. Generative research became standard operating procedure; PMs required UX deliverables before sprint planning.
- Grew the UX team from 3 to 5, then conducted initial hiring interviews for the next wave before transitioning to PwC Digital, bringing the team to 7+.

Projekt202

UX Creative Director

Feb 2014 – Nov 2016

- Led the design of The Baker, an AI-powered network recovery optimizer for Southwest Airlines that reduced mega-station shutdown recovery from 4 to 6 hours to minutes. Contributed to a 1 to 1.8 percentage point year-over-year improvement in on-time performance during severe weather events.
- Founded and grew the OpsSuite Design System across Southwest's operational software suite, including the first adaptive light/dark mode system designed for the 24-hour Network Operations Control environment.
- Directed creation of a unified design system and change management strategy at Sabre.
- Led design across industries including retail POS systems, healthcare portals, and food service (Pizza Hut online ordering), improving usability and accessibility while maintaining brand cohesion.

EXPERIENCE
CONTINUED

American Airlines

UX Creative Director

Aug 2011 – Feb 2014

- Co-led a 45-person UX and visual design team through a full rebranding of AA.com and the mobile app, modernizing a consumer platform serving millions of global travelers.
- Directed interaction and visual alignment across web and mobile surfaces, working closely with front-end developers to build the new brand identity into the codebase.
- Conducted extensive usability research including in-lab task-based validation, co-design workshops, airport-based testing, and eye-tracking studies.

Earlier Career

1997 – 2011

Interactive Art Director at Javelin Direct (5 years), delivering digital experiences for AT&T, USAA, Mitsubishi, Bank of America, and ING. Freelance UX and UI design consultant for local businesses and franchises. Junior Graphic Designer and Art Director roles building foundational skills in visual design, front-end collaboration, and campaign execution.

CREDENTIALS

EDUCATION

Communication Design
University of North Texas
1999 – 2003

Multi Media & Animation
Art Institute of Dallas
1998 – 1999

CERTIFICATIONS

- IAAP Certified Professional in Accessibility Core Competencies (CPACC)
- Nielsen Norman UX Master Certification

TOOLKIT

AI-First Delivery
Claude Code, Claude Design, Cursor, v0, ChatGPT Enterprise

Design
Figma, Creative Cloud, Miro

Development and Ops
GitHub, ADO, Deque Axe, Stark